
WDMI FILING CHECKLIST

Pigors v. McNeill et al. -- Section 1983 Civil Rights Action

I. PRE-FILING REQUIREMENTS

A. PACER / CM-ECF Registration

#	Task	Status	Notes
1	Register for PACER a..	☐	Required for electro..
2	Contact WDMI Clerk r..	☐	Some districts allow..
3	If e-filing approved..	☐	Complete ECF trainin..
4	If paper filing: Pre..	☐	See Section III below

B. Pro Se Requirements (WDMI Local Rules)

#	Requirement	Rule	Status	Notes
1	Full name, addre..	LCivR 83.2	☐	Replace all [ADD..
2	Signature on eve..	LCivR 11.1	☐	Hand signature o..
3	Caption on first..	LCivR 10.1	☐	Full case captio..
4	13-pt font (prop..	LCivR 10.6	☐	Verify in PDF co..
5	1-inch margins m..	LCivR 10.6	☐	Verify in PDF co..
6	Double-spaced (e..	LCivR 10.6	☐	Verify in PDF co..
7	Page numbers on ..	LCivR 10.6	☐	Bottom center or..
8	8.5" × 11" paper	LCivR 10.6	☐	Standard letter ..
9	Duty to prosecut..	LCivR 41.2	☐	Calendar all dea..
10	Maintain current..	LCivR 83.2	☐	Notify court of ..

C. WDMI Local Rules -- Key Provisions

Rule	Subject	Requirement
LCivR 5.6	Document Title	Must appear on first page
LCivR 5.7	Electronic Filing	PDF format required for e-fi..
LCivR 7.1(a)	Brief Page Limits	25 pages for motions (not ap..
LCivR 7.1(d)	Concurrence Statement	Required for motions (state ..
LCivR 10.1	Caption	Full caption on every document

LCivR 10.6	Format	Font, margins, spacing requi..
LCivR 11.1	Signature	Required on all filings
LCivR 16.1	Case Management	Comply with scheduling confe..
LCivR 26.1	Discovery	Local discovery procedures
LCivR 41.2	Prosecution	Diligent prosecution required
LCivR 83.2	Pro Se	Address, phone, email requir..

II. FILING PACKAGE -- DOCUMENTS

A. Primary Filing Documents

#	Document	Source File	Format	Status
1	Section 1983 Com..	01_COMPLAINT_198..	PDF	[]
2	IFP Application ..	IFP_APPLICATION_..	PDF	[]
3	Civil Cover Shee..	Complete online ..	PDF	[]
4	Summons (AO 440)..	Complete AO 440 ..	PDF	[]
5	USM-285 Process ..	Complete USM-285..	PDF	[]

B. Supporting Documents for IFP

#	Document	Status	Notes
1	Most recent federal ..	[]	Required
2	Pay stubs -- last 3 ..	[]	Or unemployment docu..
3	Bank statements -- l..	[]	Checking and savings
4	Public benefit award..	[]	SSI, TANF, SNAP, Med..
5	Child support order	[]	Showing current obli..
6	Lease / mortgage sta..	[]	Current housing costs
7	Utility bills -- mos..	[]	Electric, gas, water

C. Reference Documents (Retain for Your Records)

#	Document	Source File	Purpose
1	Immunity Defense Mat..	02_IMMUNITY_DEFENSE_..	Anticipated defense ..
2	Evidence Compilation	04_EVIDENCE_COMPILAT..	Evidence index and a..
3	Discovery Plan	05_DISCOVERY_PLAN.md	Post-filing discover..
4	Service Plan	06_SERVICE_PLAN.md	FRCP 4 service proce..
5	Filing Instructions	07_FILING_INSTRUCTIO..	Detailed CM/ECF proc..
6	Filing Readiness Score	08_FILING_READINESS_..	Risk assessment and ..

III. FILING PROCEDURES

A. Paper Filing (Recommended for Initial Pro Se Filing)

Step	Action	Details
1	Print all documents	Single-sided, 8.5" × 11", st..
2	Prepare originals + copies	Original for court + 1 copy ..
3	Complete Civil Cover Sheet (..	See Section IV below
4	Complete AO 440 Summons × 5	One for each defendant
5	Complete USM-285 × 5	One for each defendant
6	Sign all documents	Blue ink recommended for ori..
7	Include self-addressed stamp..	For file-stamped copies to b..
8	File in person or by mail	See addresses below

B. Filing Locations

Location	Address	Hours
Grand Rapids (Primary -- Sou..	Gerald R. Ford Federal Build..	M-F 8:30 AM - 4:30 PM
Kalamazoo (Alternate)	410 W Michigan Ave, Kalamazo..	M-F 8:30 AM - 4:30 PM
Mail Filing	Clerk of Court, USDC-WDMI, 3..	N/A

C. Filing Day -- Step-by-Step

#	Action	[]
1	Verify ALL placeholder field..	[]
2	Verify ALL documents are sig..	[]
3	Verify IFP Application has a..	[]
4	Verify supporting financial ..	[]
5	Print original + 6 copies of..	[]
6	Print original + 1 copy of I..	[]
7	Complete and print JS-44 Civ..	[]
8	Complete and print AO 440 Su..	[]
9	Complete and print USM-285 × 5	[]
10	Include SASE for file-stampe..	[]
11	Submit entire package to Clerk	[]
12	Request and retain receipt o..	[]

IV. JS-44 CIVIL COVER SHEET -- COMPLETION GUIDE

Field	Entry
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Plaintiff	ANDREW J. PIGORS
County of Residence -- Plaintiff	Muskegon
Defendant	HON. JENNY L. McNEILL, et al.
County of Residence -- Defendant	Muskegon
Attorneys -- Plaintiff	PRO SE
Attorneys -- Defendant	[Leave blank -- to be completed by Defendan..
Basis of Jurisdiction	Box 3 -- Federal Question (U.S. Government ..
Citizenship of Principal Parties	N/A for federal question
Nature of Suit	440 -- Other Civil Rights
Origin	1 -- Original Proceeding
Cause of Action	42 USC § 1983 -- Deprivation of civil right..
Brief Description	Civil rights action challenging deprivation..
Jury Demand	Yes -- Plaintiff
Related Cases	[] Check if yes -- No related federal cases
Class Action	No

V. SUMMONS (AO 440) -- COMPLETION GUIDE

Complete one AO 440 form for each Defendant:

Defendant	Name on Summons	Service Address
1. McNeill	HON. JENNY L. McNEILL (Indiv..	[Personal address or 990 Ter..
2. Watson	TIFFANY A. WATSON	[Last known residential addr..
3. Barnes	PAMELA BARNES (P55406) (Indi..	[State Bar registered address]
4. County	MUSKEGON COUNTY (c/o County ..	990 Terrace Street, Muskegon..
5. FOC	14TH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT,..	990 Terrace Street, Muskegon..

VI. POST-FILING TIMELINE

Event	Deadline	Rule	Action Required
Case Assignment	Same day or within d..	--	Note case number and..
IFP Ruling	14-30 days (typical)	28 USC § 1915	If denied, pay \$405 ..
§ 1915(e)(2) Screening	With IFP ruling	28 USC § 1915(e)(2)	Court screens for fr..
Service of Process	90 days from filing	FRCP 4(m)	If IFP granted, U.S...
Defendant Response	21 days from service..	FRCP 12(a)(1)	Calendar each defend..
Defendant Response	60 days from service..	FRCP 12(a)(2)	Calendar separately
FRCP 26(f) Conference	Per scheduling order	FRCP 26(f)	Meet and confer with..
Initial Disclosures	14 days after 26(f)	FRCP 26(a)(1)	Exchange initial dis..
Scheduling Conference	Per court order	FRCP 16	Appear as scheduled

VII. STATUTE OF LIMITATIONS VERIFICATION

All federal claims confirmed within SOL (3-year Michigan tort SOL borrowed for § 1983):

Count	Claim	SOL Expiration	Days Remaining	Status
I	Substantive Due ..	2029-03-02	1,094	[GREEN] GREEN
II	Procedural Due P..	2029-03-02	1,094	[GREEN] GREEN
III	Equal Protection	2029-01-15	1,048	[GREEN] GREEN
IV	§ 1985 Conspiracy	2029-02-27	1,091	[GREEN] GREEN
V	§ 1986 Failure t..	2029-02-27	1,091	[GREEN] GREEN
VI	Monell Liability	2029-03-02	1,094	[GREEN] GREEN
VII	First Amendment ..	2029-02-27	1,091	[GREEN] GREEN

Source: sol_audit_results table, litigation_context.db

VIII. KEY CONTACTS

Office	Contact	Phone	Address
Clerk of Court, WDMI	Clerk's Office	(616) 456-2381	110 Michigan St NW, ..
U.S. Marshals, WDMI	Marshals Office	(616) 456-2438	Gerald R. Ford Feder..
PACER Service Center	Help Desk	(800) 676-6856	https://pacer.uscour..
WDMI Court Website	--	--	https://www.miwd.usc..
Pro Se Resources	--	--	https://www.miwd.usc..
WDMI Local Rules	--	--	https://www.miwd.usc..

IX. CRITICAL REMINDERS

[!] Before Filing

- [] Timing Decision: Confirm whether state proceedings have concluded (Younger abstention risk if pending)
- [] Complete ALL blanks in Complaint and IFP Application -- no placeholders
- [] Verify all dates against official court records
- [] Verify all defendant names are spelled correctly

- ☐ Verify defendant addresses are current
- ☐ Attach all IFP supporting documents (tax returns, bank statements, etc.)
- ☐ Consider attorney consultation -- even limited-scope review recommended

[!] After Filing

- ☐ Retain file-stamped copies of everything
 - ☐ Note case number and judge immediately
 - ☐ Calendar ALL deadlines -- missing a deadline can be fatal
 - ☐ Monitor IFP ruling -- respond promptly if additional information requested
 - ☐ Follow up with Marshals within 30 days to verify service progress
 - ☐ Prepare for § 1915(e)(2) screening -- complaint designed to survive
 - ☐ Prepare for Motion to Dismiss -- review immunity matrix
(02_IMMUNITY_DEFENSE_MATRIX.md)
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Filing Checklist Finalized: 2026-03-04

Case: Pigors v. McNeill et al. -- WDMI Section 1983